ALLAMAHUL BAYAN SERIES · BOOK 46

عَلَّمَهُ الْبَيَانَ

# My First Japanese Alphabet

## はじめての ひらがな

A Coloring Book to Learn, Trace & Say the 46 Japanese Hiragana Letters with English Phonetics

あ い う え お

**Written by Hafez Abdullah Muhammad Minhaz Reza**

Illustrations: AI-assisted, edited by the author

**Maktabatu Kunujul Akhirah**

مكتبة كنوز الآخرة

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**My First Japanese Alphabet** — はじめての ひらがな
Allamahul Bayan Series, Book 46

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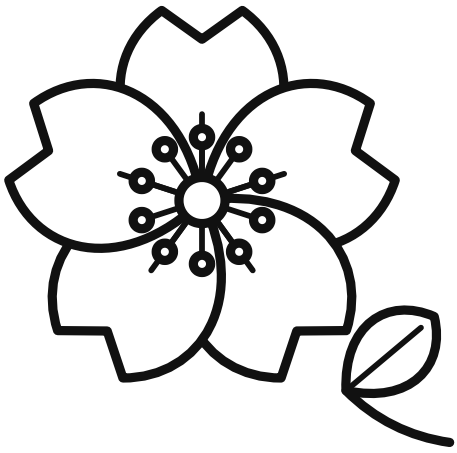
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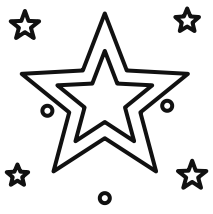
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**A note of respect:** this book contains verses of the Noble Qur'an (pages 4–5). Please handle it with care and keep it in a clean place.

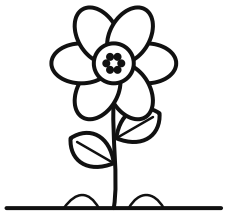


# This book belongs to
## この ほんの もちぬし

I started learning Japanese on







ABOUT THIS SERIES

# The Allamahul Bayan Series

عَلَّمَهُ الْبَيَانَ

*ʿallamahul-bayān — "He taught him clear expression"*

الرَّحْمَٰنُ ﴿١﴾ عَلَّمَ الْقُرْآنَ ﴿٢﴾ خَلَقَ الْإِنسَانَ ﴿٣﴾ عَلَّمَهُ الْبَيَانَ ﴿٤﴾

*Ar-Raḥmān. ʿAllamal-Qurʾān. Khalaqal-insān. ʿAllamahul-bayān.*

"The Most Merciful. He taught the Qur'an. He created the human being. He taught him clear expression (al-bayān)."

**Surah Ar-Raḥmān 55:1–4**[1]

Surah Ar-Raḥmān — the chapter of *The Most Merciful* — opens by naming some of Allah's greatest gifts to us. First, **He taught the Qur'an**. Then, **He created the human being**. And then, **He taught him al-bayān**.

**What does *al-bayān* mean?** It comes from an Arabic root that means *to make something clear*. Al-bayān is the gift of speech and understanding: being able to put what is in our hearts and minds into words, to explain, to listen, and to be understood. Animals make sounds, but only people were taught to speak, read and write in languages. Scholars of tafsīr explain that this gift is what lets us learn, teach and pass on guidance — including the Qur'an itself.

So every time a child says a new word, sounds out a letter, or writes their first line in a new language, they are using a gift that Allah Himself says He taught. That is the heart of this series: **learning languages as a way of thanking Allah for al-bayān.**

# Languages and colours: two signs of Allah

وَمِنْ آيَاتِهِ خَلْقُ السَّمَاوَاتِ وَالْأَرْضِ وَاخْتِلَافُ أَلْسِنَتِكُمْ وَأَلْوَانِكُمْ ۚ إِنَّ فِي ذَٰلِكَ لَآيَاتٍ لِّلْعَالِمِينَ ﴿٢٢﴾

*Wa min āyātihī khalqus-samāwāti wal-arḍi wakh-tilāfu alsinatikum wa alwānikum. Inna fī dhālika la-āyātil-lil-ʿālimīn.*

"And among His signs is the creation of the heavens and the earth, and the variety of your languages and your colours. Surely in that are signs for those who know."

**Surah Ar-Rūm 30:22**[1]

In Surah Ar-Rūm, Allah tells us that the **many languages** of people and their **many colours** are among His signs. A coloring book that teaches a language brings both of these signs together in a child's hands: they meet a new language, and they fill its letters with colour.

وَجَعَلْنَاكُمْ شُعُوبًا وَقَبَائِلَ لِتَعَارَفُوا

*Wa jaʿalnākum shuʿūban wa qabāʾila li-taʿārafū.*

"...and We made you into peoples and tribes so that you may get to know one another."

**Surah Al-Ḥujurāt 49:13 (part)**[1]

Allah made us into many peoples *so that we may get to know one another*. Learning even a few letters of someone's language is a beautiful first step towards knowing them.

### How each book in the series works

Every book introduces one language **through English**:

- where the language is spoken, with a map to color;
- every letter of its alphabet, with its name in the language itself *and* in English letters;
- simple English sound guides, so a parent who has never heard the language can still help;
- a word and picture for every letter, to color, trace and say out loud.

**Book 46 is Japanese**. More languages from around the world are in the series, in shā' Allāh.

FOR PARENTS AND TEACHERS

# How to use this book

Begin with **Bismillah**, and go **little and often**: one letter a day is plenty for a young child. For each letter:

1. **Say it.** Read the letter's name and its sound guide together. Say it three times.
2. **Color it.** Color the big letter any way your child likes.
3. **Trace it.** Trace the dotted letters with a pencil, then try one alone in the empty boxes.
4. **Meet the word.** Say the word, color the picture, and talk about it in English.

**Marker tip:** every coloring page has a blank back, so colours cannot spoil the next activity. Slip a sheet of scrap paper behind the page you are coloring anyway — it keeps the next page clean.

### Reading the English sound guides

- Every hiragana is **one beat**. **Doubled vowels** (aa, ii, uu, oo) are long: hold them for two beats, as in *fuusen* (balloon) and *chikyuu* (the Earth). **ei** sounds like a long 'e'.
- The vowels are short and pure: **a** as in "father", **i** as in "see", **u** as in "moon", **e** as in "bed", **o** as in "go".
- A **doubled consonant** (kk, pp, tt) means a tiny pause before it: *sek-ken*, *rak-kasei*.
- Japanese has **no strong stress**: say every beat evenly. The English letters follow **Hepburn romaji** (shi, chi, tsu, fu).

### Three ways to see every sound

Each letter page shows the sound three ways: the letter's **Japanese name** written in Japanese (native phonetics), the **same name in English letters**, and an **English sound guide**. The box marked *Fifty-sound chart · katakana* shows the letter in its row of the hiragana chart (the letter in the box is the one on the page), its katakana twin, and the new letter it makes with the two dots ゛ or the circle ゜.

The pronunciation guides are simplified for young learners and follow standard Tokyo Japanese.

MEET THE LANGUAGE

# Hello, Japanese! にほんご

*nihongo (in kanji: 日本語) — the Japanese word for the language*

**Who speaks it?**
About **125 million people** speak Japanese.[3]

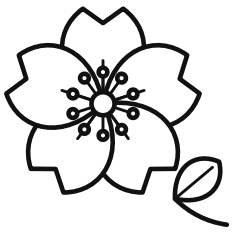
**Where?**
In **Japan**, a country of thousands of islands in East Asia, and in Japanese families around the world.

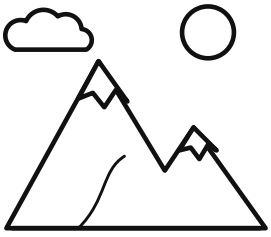
**How is it written?**
With three scripts together: **hiragana**, **katakana** and **kanji**. Usually left to right, but many books are written from top to bottom.

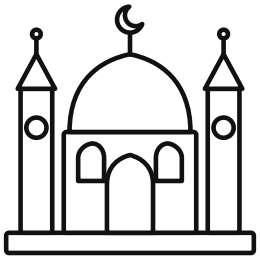
**How many letters?**
**46 basic hiragana**. Two little dots ゛ or a circle ゜ make more sounds: か ka → が ga.

**Two shapes, one sound**
Every hiragana has a **katakana** twin, used for words from other languages: あ ア · か カ · さ サ.

**Did you know?**
In their first year of school, Japanese children learn **80 kanji**, like 山 (mountain) and 木 (tree).







# The Japanese Alphabet ごじゅうおん

### 5 vowels – あいうえお

| | | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| あ *a* | い *i* | う *u* | え *e* | お *o* |

### 15 letters of the K, S and T rows – か・さ・た

| | | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| か *ka* | き *ki* | く *ku* | け *ke* | こ *ko* |
| さ *sa* | し *shi* | す *su* | せ *se* | そ *so* |
| た *ta* | ち *chi* | つ *tsu* | て *te* | と *to* |

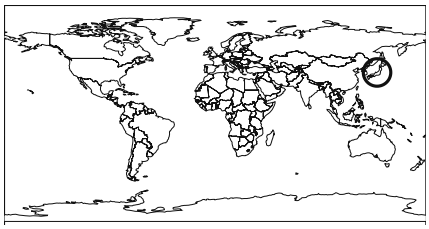
### 15 letters of the N, H and M rows – な・は・ま

| | | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| な *na* | に *ni* | ぬ *nu* | ね *ne* | の *no* |
| は *ha* | ひ *hi* | ふ *fu* | へ *he* | ほ *ho* |
| ま *ma* | み *mi* | む *mu* | め *me* | も *mo* |

### 11 letters of the Y, R and W rows, and ん – や・ら・わ・ん

| | | | | | | | | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| や *ya* | ゆ *yu* | よ *yo* | ら *ra* | り *ri* | る *ru* | れ *re* | ろ *ro* | わ *wa* | を *o* | ん *n* |

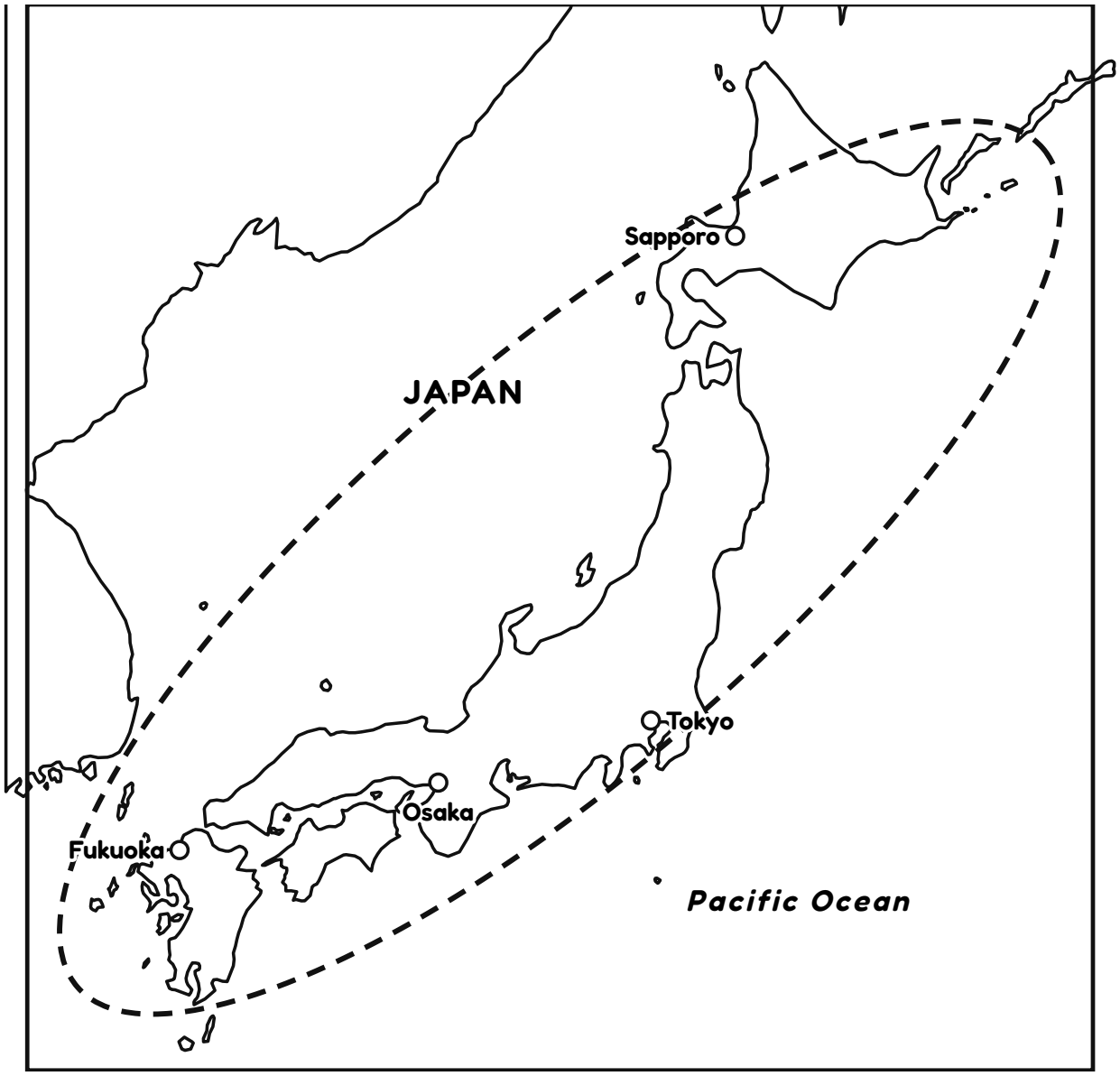
Read the alphabet row by row — the same order as in this book.



The circle shows Japan on the world map.

COLOR THE MAP

# Where is Japanese spoken?




**Color it:** the land **green** · the sea **blue**. **Find it:** Japanese is spoken all over Japan: in Tokyo, Osaka, Sapporo and Fukuoka, on the four big islands and on many small ones, down to Okinawa in the south.

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# The Vowels あいうえお

*a i u e o — the five vowels*

Japanese is written with **three kinds of letters** that work together in the same sentence.

**Hiragana ひらがな**
Round, flowing letters. Each one is a whole sound, one beat: か is *ka*, き is *ki*. There are **46 basic hiragana**, and children learn them first. This book teaches all 46.

**Katakana カタカナ**
A twin set of sharper letters with the same sounds, used for words from other languages: *I* パン *pan*, bread. Every page shows the katakana twin: あ ア.

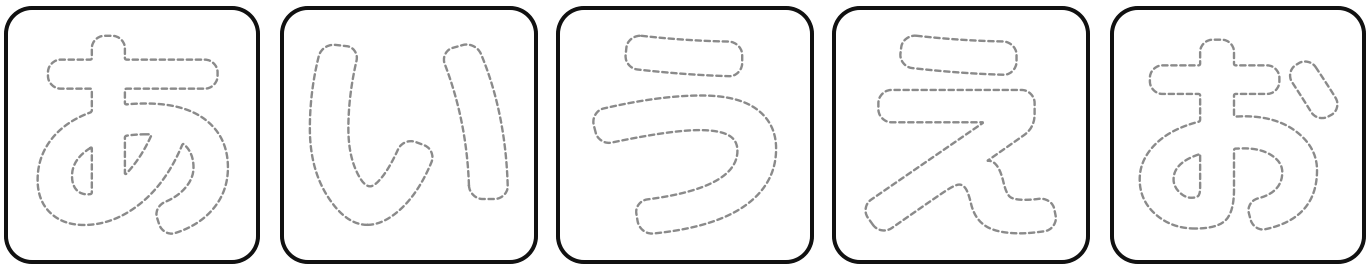
**Kanji 漢字**
Characters that came from Chinese. Each one stands for a word or idea: 山 *yama*, mountain · 木 *ki*, tree · 日 *hi*, sun. Children learn them little by little at school.

**The fifty-sound chart ごじゅうおん**
The five vowels あ い う え お make the first row. Every other row adds one consonant to them: か き く け こ is *ka ki ku ke ko*. This book follows the chart, row by row.

PENCIL WARM-UP

# Trace the vowels あいうえお

Use a **pencil**. Say each letter's name as you trace it.



あ

**NAME · なまえ**

**あ**

*a*

**SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE**

'a' as in "father"

**FIFTY-SOUND CHART · KATAKANA**

あ い う え お

Katakana twin: ア



**あ IS FOR**

# あめ

*ame*

**rain**

Color the picture and say the word three times!

**TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · かいてみよう**

あ あ あ あ

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い

**NAME · なまえ**

**い**

*i*

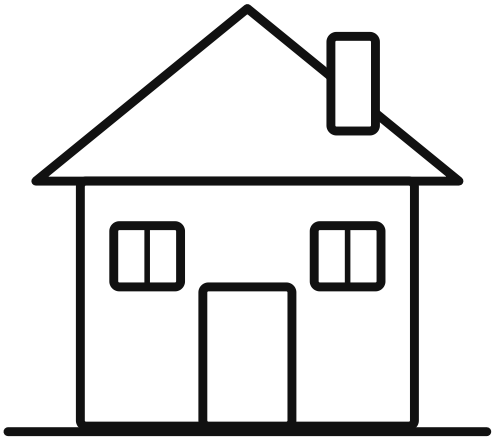
**SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE**

'ee' as in "see", short

**FIFTY-SOUND CHART · KATAKANA**

あ [い] う え お

Katakana twin: イ



**い IS FOR**

# いえ

*ie*

**house**

Color the picture and say the word three times!

**TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · かいてみよう**

い い い い い

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う

**NAME · なまえ**

う

*u*

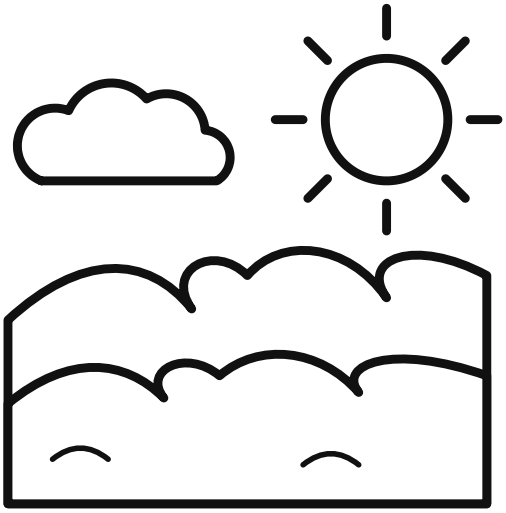
**SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE**

‘oo’ as in “moon”, short, with relaxed lips

**FIFTY-SOUND CHART · KATAKANA**

あ い **[う]** え お

Katakana twin: ウ



**う IS FOR**

# うみ

*umi*

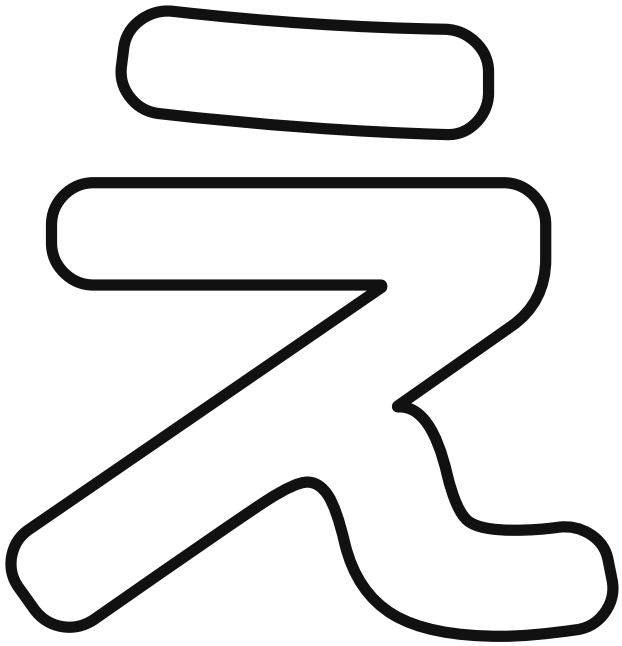
**sea**

Color the picture and say the word three times!

**TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · かいてみよう**

う う う う

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**NAME · なまえ**

# え

*e*

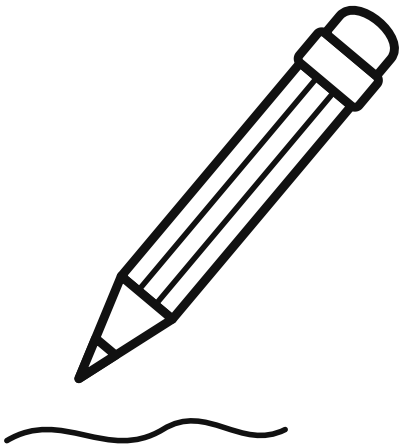
**SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE**

'e' as in "bed"

**FIFTY-SOUND CHART · KATAKANA**

あ い う **え** お

Katakana twin: エ



**え IS FOR**

# えんぴつ

*enpitsu*

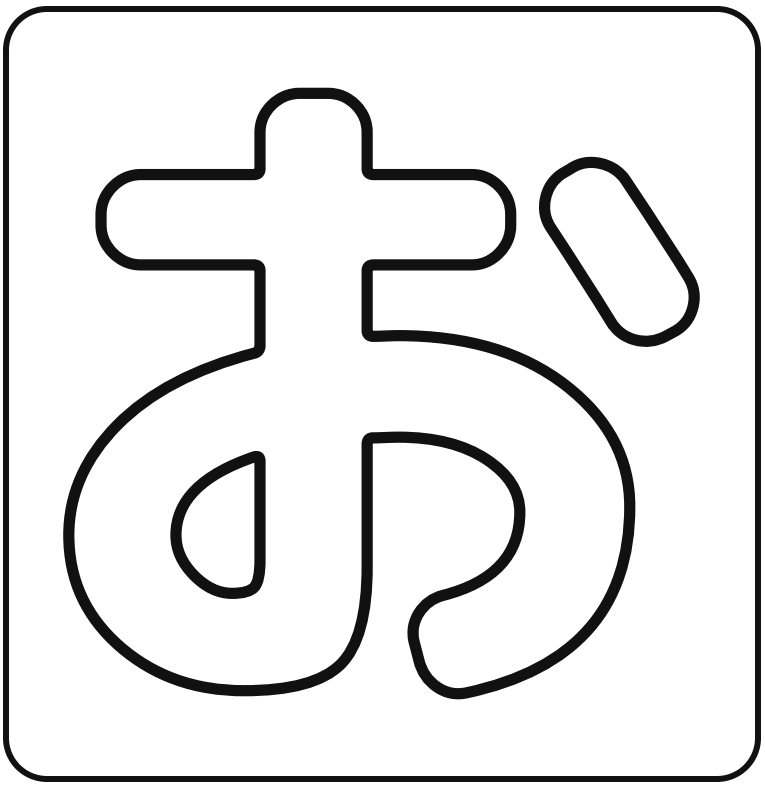
**pencil**

Color the picture and say the word three times!

**TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · かいてみよう**

え え え え

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NAME · なまえ

# お

*o*

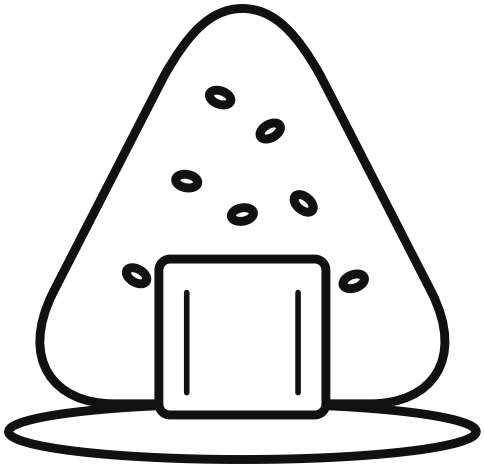
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

'o' as in "go", short and round

FIFTY-SOUND CHART · KATAKANA

あ い う え お

Katakana twin: オ



お IS FOR

# おにぎり

*onigiri*

**rice ball**

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · かいてみよう

お お お お

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ROWS K · S · T

# The K, S and T Rows か・さ・た

*ka, sa, ta*

Each row joins one consonant to the five vowels: **K** + a, i, u, e, o = か き く け こ.

**Watch out for three letters**
Three letters do not follow the pattern: し is *shi*, ち is *chi* and つ is *tsu*.

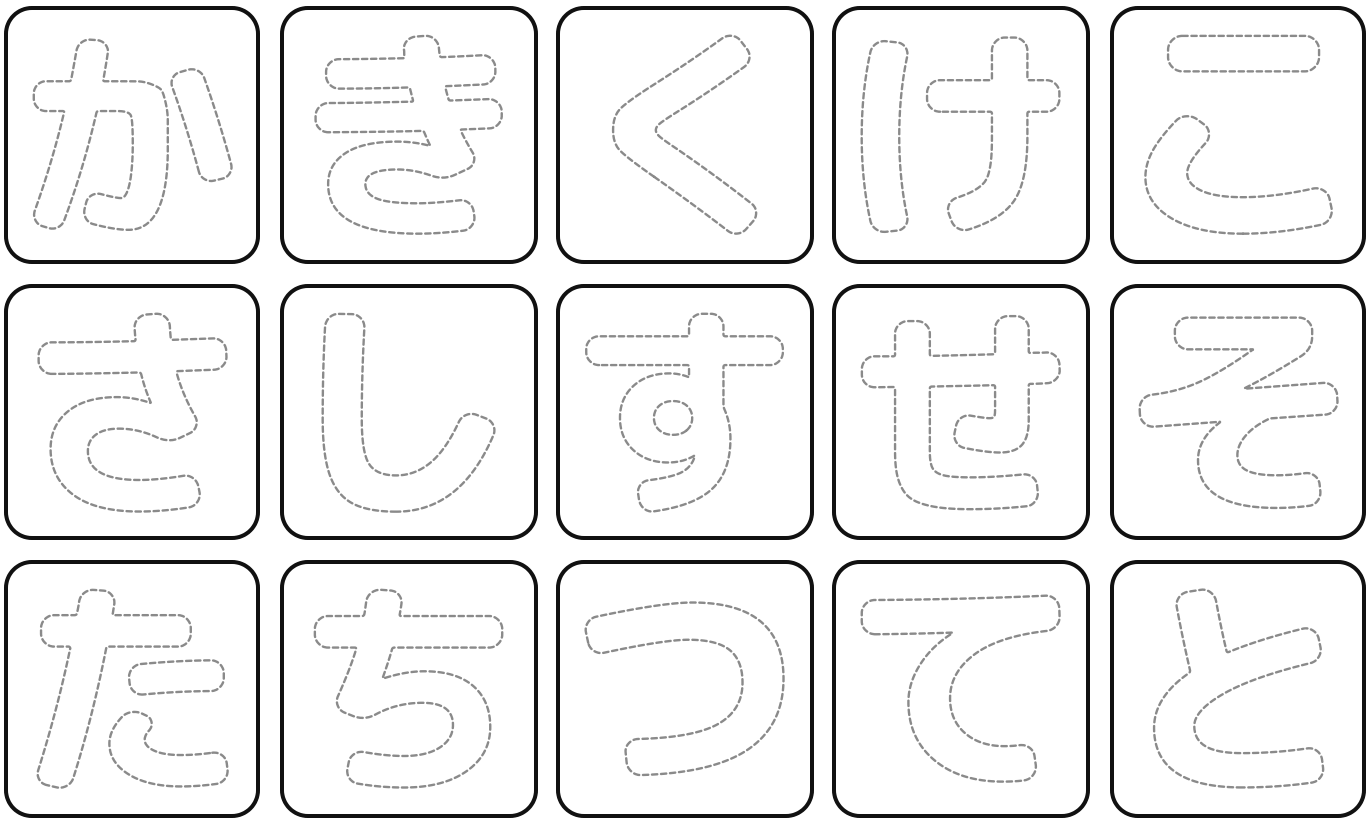
**Two little dots ゛**
Two dots at the top right make the sound buzzy: か → が (*ga*), さ → ざ (*za*), た → だ (*da*).

**A small っ**
A small っ means “hold for a beat”: せっけん is *sek-ken*, soap.

PENCIL WARM-UP

# Trace the K, S and T rows か・さ・た

Use a **pencil**. Say each letter's name as you trace it.



# か

**NAME · なまえ**

**か**

*ka*

**SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE**

'kah'

**FIFTY-SOUND CHART · KATAKANA**

か き く け こ

Katakana twin: カ · with ゛ : が *ga*



**か IS FOR**

## かさ

*kasa*

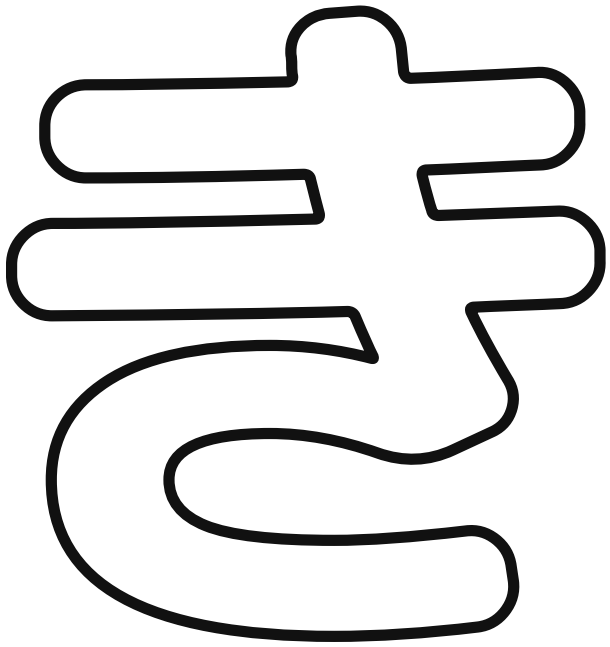
**umbrella**

Color the picture and say the word three times!

**TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · かいてみよう**

か か か か

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**NAME · なまえ**

# き

*ki*

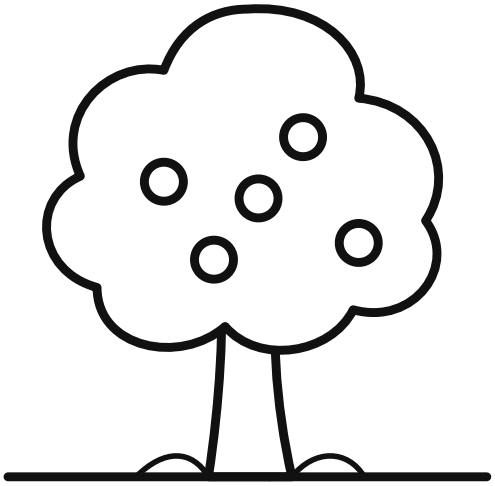
**SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE**

'kee' as in "key"

**FIFTY-SOUND CHART · KATAKANA**

か **き** く け こ

Katakana twin: キ · with ゛ : ぎ *gi*



**き IS FOR**

# き

*ki*

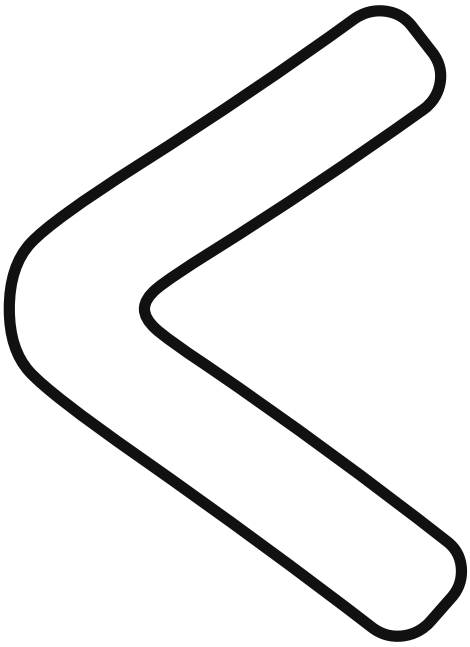
**tree**

Color the picture and say the word three times!

**TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · かいてみよう**

き き き き

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**NAME · なまえ**

く

*ku*

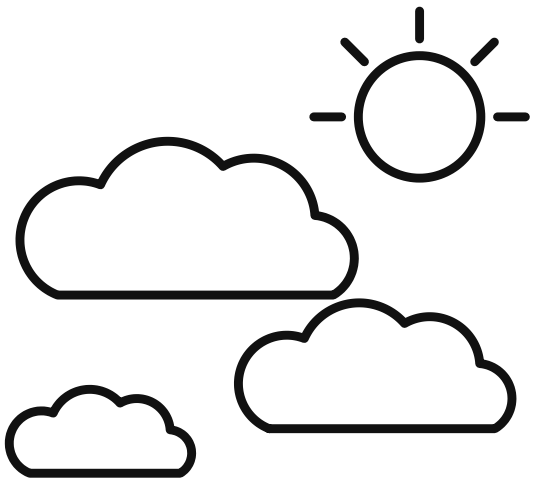
**SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE**

‘koo’ as in “cool”

**FIFTY-SOUND CHART · KATAKANA**

か き **く** け こ

Katakana twin: ク · with ゛ : ぐ *gu*



**く IS FOR**

# くも

*kumo*

**cloud**

Color the picture and say the word three times!

**TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · かいてみよう**

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# け

**NAME · なまえ**

け

*ke*

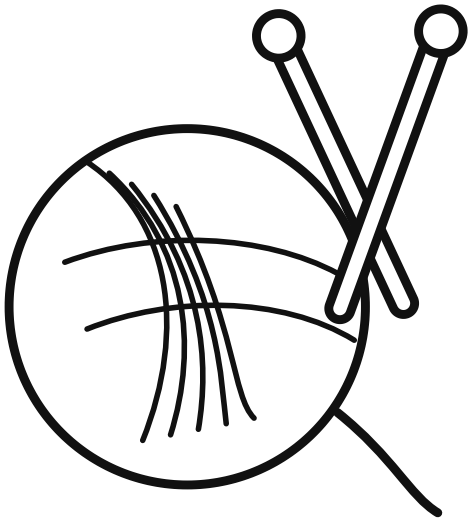
**SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE**

‘ke’ as in “kettle”

**FIFTY-SOUND CHART · KATAKANA**

か き く **け** こ

Katakana twin: ケ · with ゛ : げ *ge*



**け IS FOR**

## けいと

*keito*

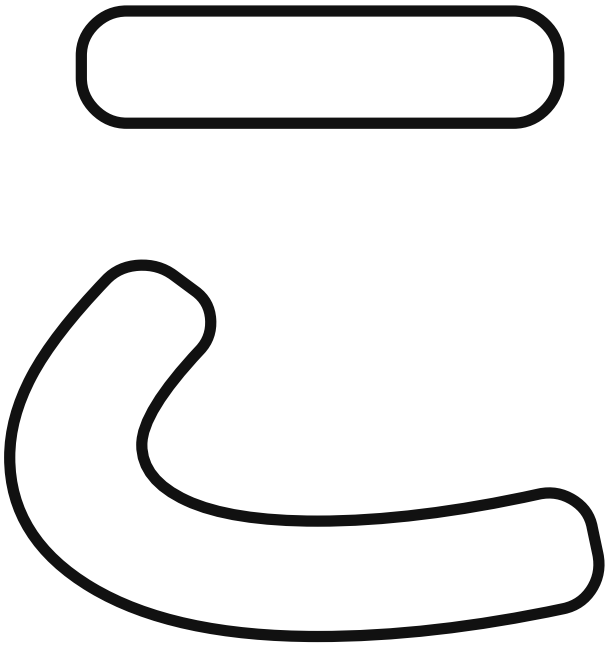
**knitting wool**

Color the picture and say the word three times!

**TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · かいてみよう**

け け け け

This page is left blank on purpose, so your colours don’t bleed through. ✿



**NAME · なまえ**

こ

*ko*

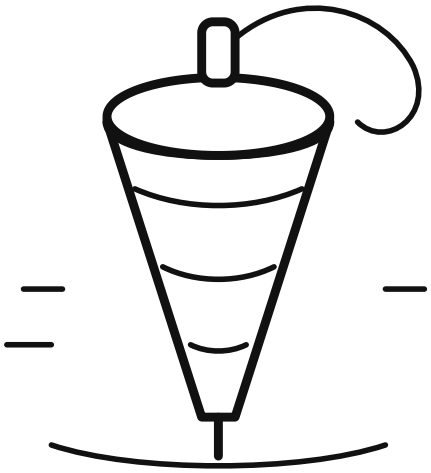
**SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE**

‘ko’ as in “coat”, short

**FIFTY-SOUND CHART · KATAKANA**

か き く け こ

Katakana twin: コ · with ゛ : ご *go*



**こ IS FOR**

# こま

*koma*

**spinning top**

Color the picture and say the word three times!

**TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · かいてみよう**

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# さ

**NAME · なまえ**

さ

*sa*

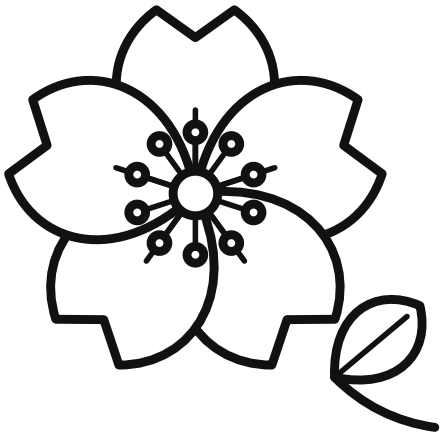
**SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE**

'sah'

**FIFTY-SOUND CHART · KATAKANA**

さ し す せ そ

Katakana twin: サ · with ゛ : ざ *za*



**さ IS FOR**

## さくら

*sakura*

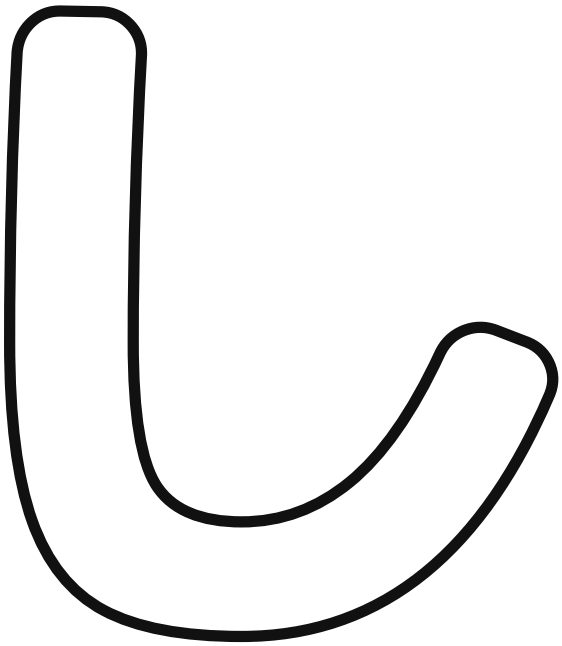
**cherry blossom**

Color the picture and say the word three times!

**TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · かいてみよう**

さ さ さ さ

This page is left blank on purpose, so your colours don’t bleed through. ✿



**NAME · なまえ**

# し

*shi*

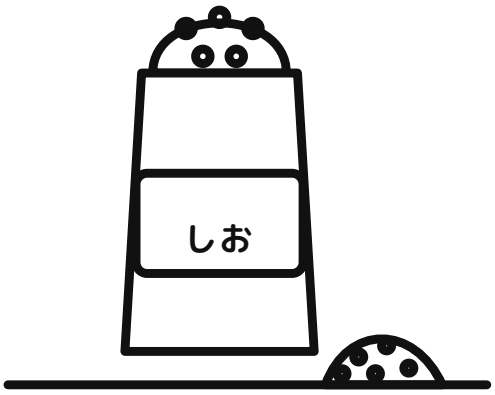
**SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE**

'shee' as in "sheep", not "see"!

**FIFTY-SOUND CHART · KATAKANA**

さ **[し]** す せ そ

Katakana twin: シ · with ゛ : じ *ji*




**し IS FOR**

# しお

*shio*

**salt**

Color the picture and say the word three times!

**TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · かいてみよう**

し し し し

This page is left blank on purpose, so your colours don’t bleed through. ✿

す

**NAME · なまえ**

**す**

*su*

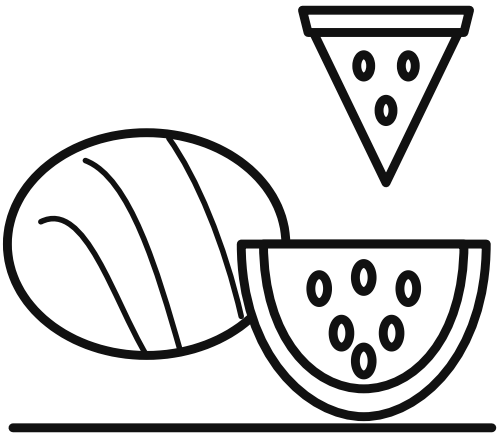
**SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE**

‘soo’, often said very softly

**FIFTY-SOUND CHART · KATAKANA**

さ し **す** せ そ

Katakana twin: ス · with ゛ : ず *zu*



**す IS FOR**

# すいか

*suika*

**watermelon**

Color the picture and say the word three times!

**TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · かいてみよう**

す す す す

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# せ

**NAME · なまえ**

せ

*se*

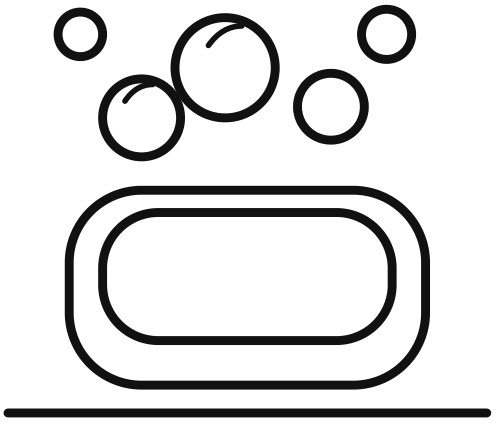
**SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE**

'se' as in "set"

**FIFTY-SOUND CHART · KATAKANA**

さ し す **せ** そ

Katakana twin: セ · with ゛ : ぜ *ze*



**せ IS FOR**

## せっけん

*sekken*

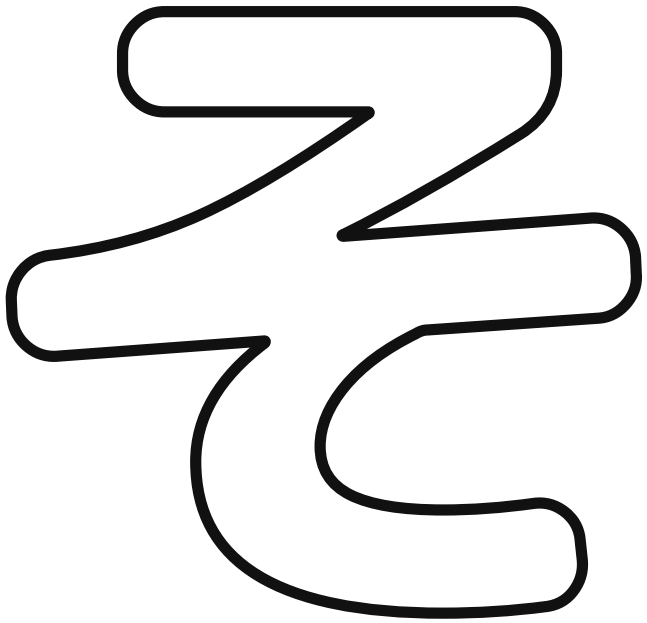
**soap**

Color the picture and say the word three times!

**TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · かいてみよう**

せ せ せ せ

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**NAME · なまえ**

# そ

*so*

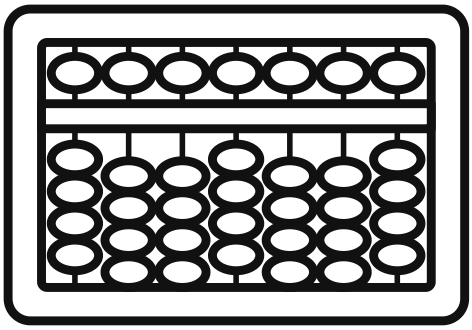
**SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE**

'so' as in "soap", short

**FIFTY-SOUND CHART · KATAKANA**

さ し す せ **そ**

Katakana twin: ソ · with ゛ : ぞ *zo*



**そ IS FOR**

# そろばん

*soroban*

**abacus (a counting frame)**

Color the picture and say the word three times!

**TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · かいてみよう**

そ そ そ そ

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# た

**NAME · なまえ**

**た**

*ta*

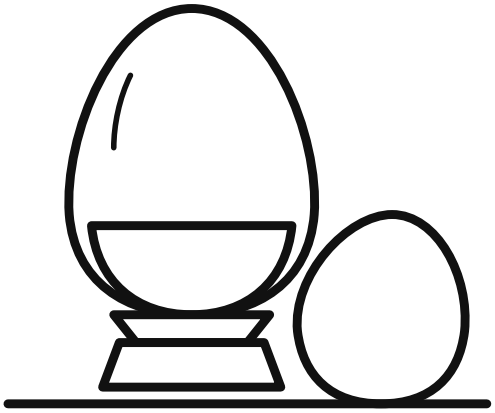
**SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE**

'tah'

**FIFTY-SOUND CHART · KATAKANA**

| | | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| た | ち | つ | て | と |

Katakana twin: タ · with ゛ : だ *da*



**た IS FOR**

## たまご

*tamago*

**egg**

Color the picture and say the word three times!

**TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · かいてみよう**

た た た た

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# ち

**NAME · なまえ**

**ち**

*chi*

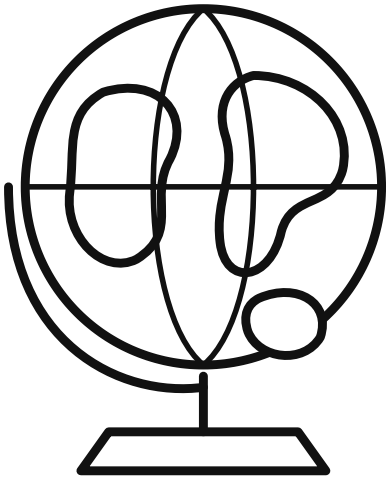
**SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE**

‘chee’ as in “cheese”

**FIFTY-SOUND CHART · KATAKANA**

た **ち** つ て と

Katakana twin: チ · with ゛ : ぢ *ji*



**ち IS FOR**

## ちきゅう

*chikyuu*

**the Earth**

Color the picture and say the word three times!

**TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · かいてみよう**

ち ち ち ち

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つ

**NAME · なまえ**

つ

*tsu*

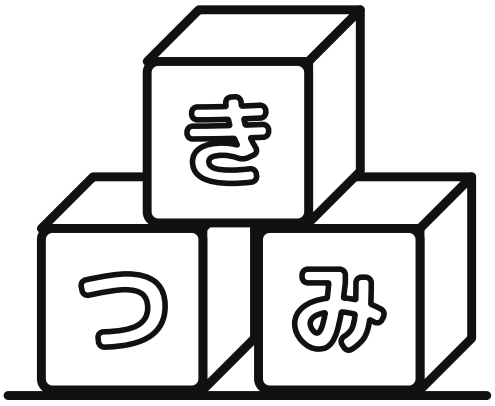
**SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE**

'ts' as at the end of "cats", then 'oo'

**FIFTY-SOUND CHART · KATAKANA**

た ち つ て と

Katakana twin: ツ · with ゛ : づ *zu*




**つ IS FOR**

# つみき

*tsumiki*

**building blocks**

Color the picture and say the word three times!

**TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · かいてみよう**

つ つ つ つ

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# て

**NAME · なまえ**

て

*te*

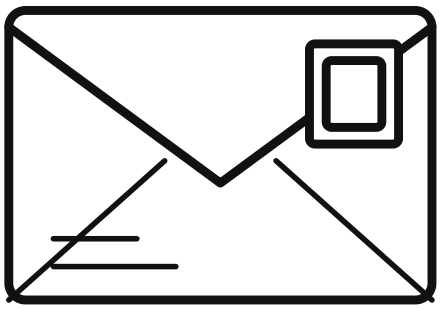
**SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE**

'te' as in "ten"

**FIFTY-SOUND CHART · KATAKANA**

た ち つ **[て]** と

Katakana twin: テ · with ゛ : で *de*



**て IS FOR**

## てがみ

*tegami*

**letter (to post)**

Color the picture and say the word three times!

**TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · かいてみよう**

て て て て

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と

**NAME · なまえ**

と

*to*

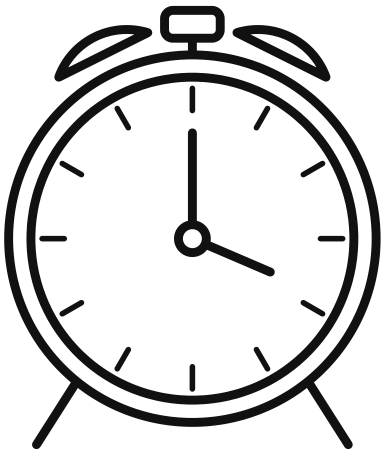
**SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE**

'to' as in "toe", short

**FIFTY-SOUND CHART · KATAKANA**

た ち つ て **と**

Katakana twin: ト · with ゛ : ど *do*



**と IS FOR**

# とけい

*tokei*

**clock**

Color the picture and say the word three times!

**TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · かいてみよう**

と と と と

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ROWS N · H · M

# The N, H and M Rows な・は・ま

*na*, *ha*, *ma*

Three more rows: **N**, **H** and **M**.

**A soft f**
ふ is *fu*: blow gently through your lips, as if cooling a hot drink.

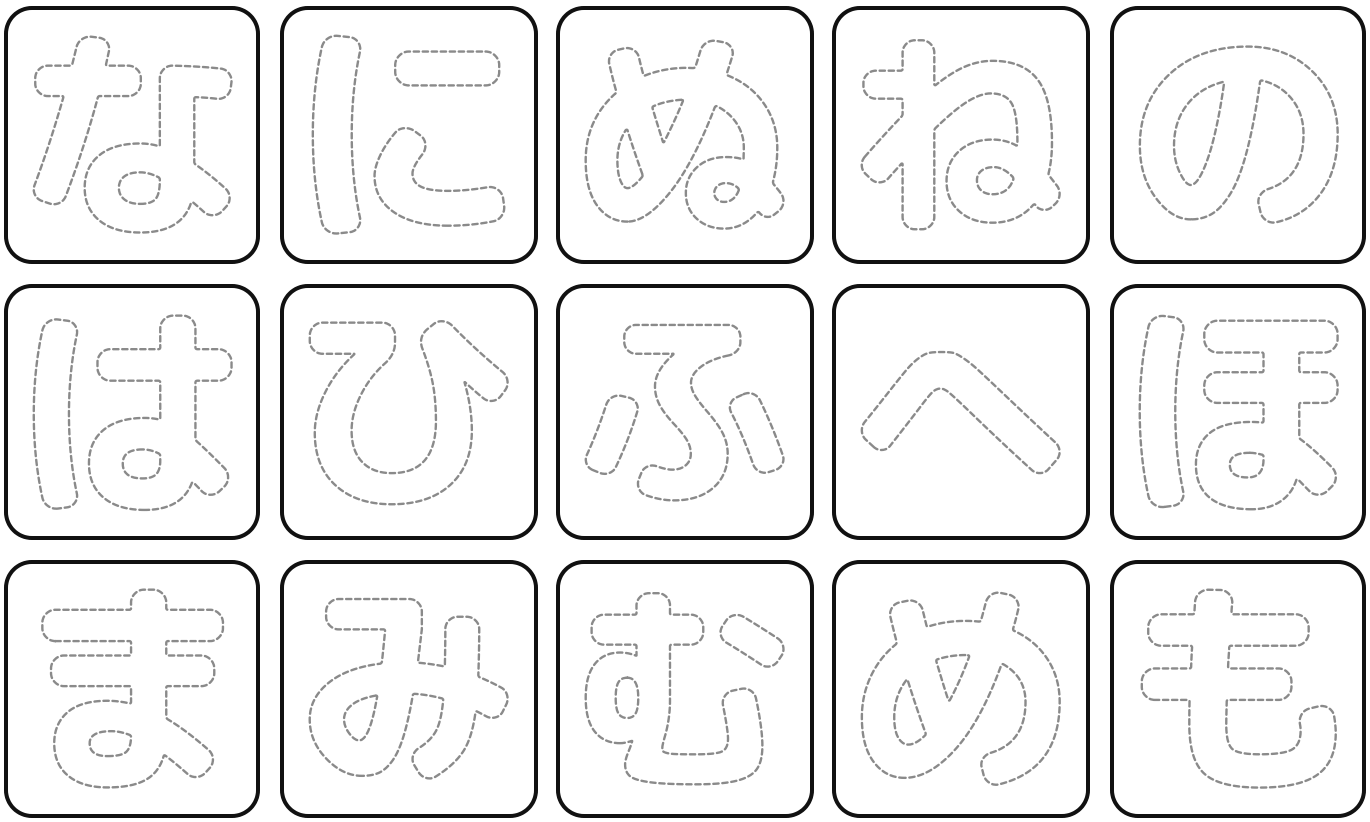
**Dots and a circle**
The H row can wear two dots or a little circle: は → ば (*ba*), は → ぱ (*pa*).

**Look closely**
Some letters are cousins: ぬ and め differ only by a little loop, and so do ね and れ. Trace them slowly!

PENCIL WARM-UP

# Trace the N, H and M rows な・は・ま

Use a **pencil**. Say each letter's name as you trace it.



# な

**NAME · なまえ**

## な

*na*

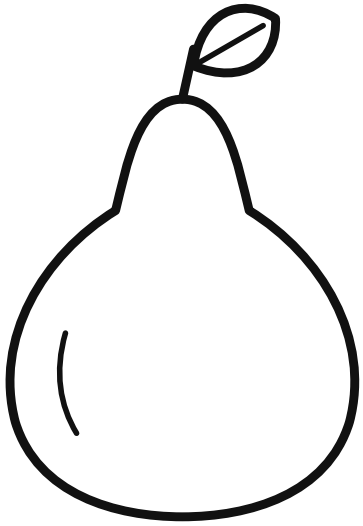
**SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE**

'nah'

**FIFTY-SOUND CHART · KATAKANA**

[な] に ぬ ね の

Katakana twin: ナ



**な IS FOR**

## なし

*nashi*

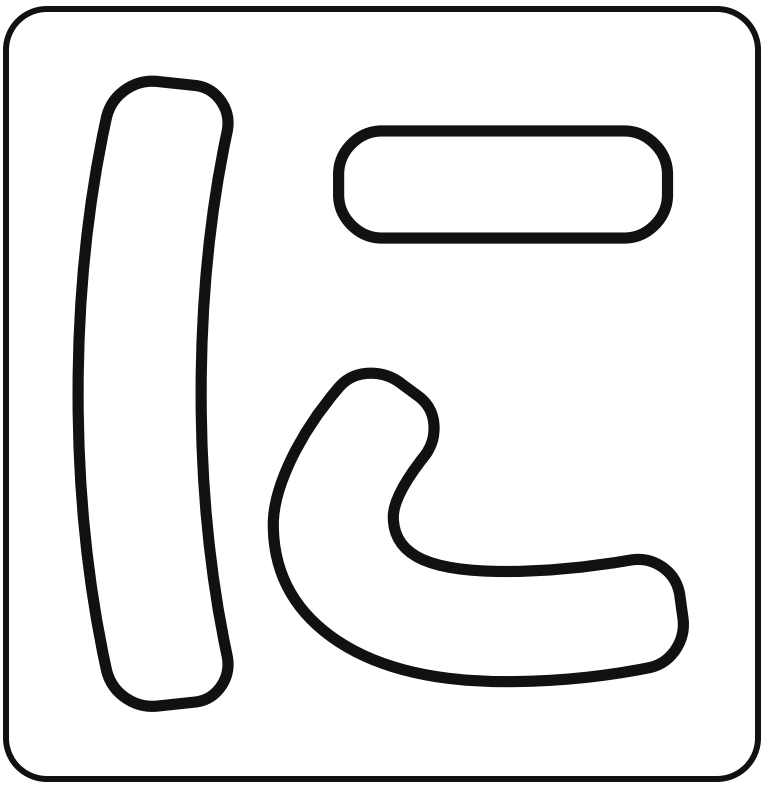
**pear**

Color the picture and say the word three times!

**TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · かいてみよう**

な な な な

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**NAME · なまえ**

# に

*ni*

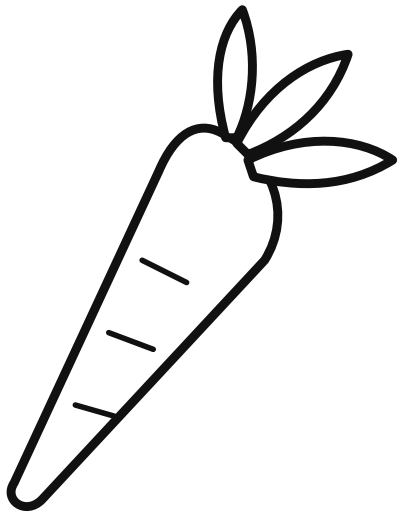
**SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE**

‘nee’ as in “knee”

**FIFTY-SOUND CHART · KATAKANA**

な **に** ぬ ね の

Katakana twin: ニ



**に IS FOR**

# にんじん

*ninjin*

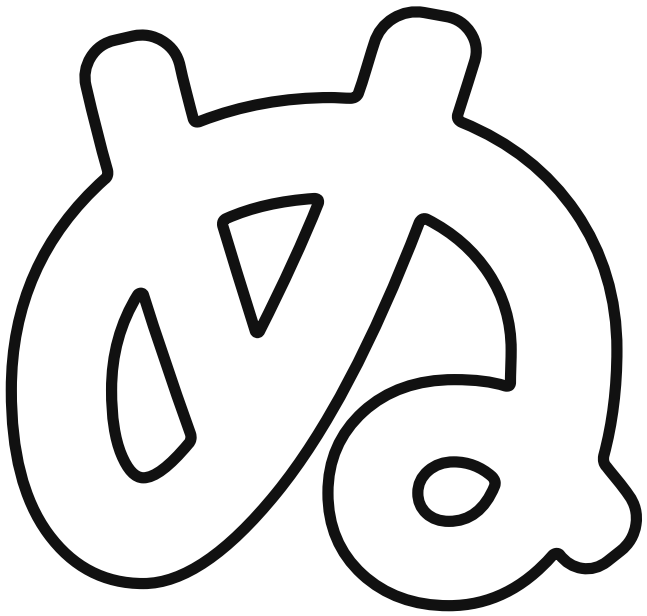
**carrot**

Color the picture and say the word three times!

**TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · かいてみよう**

に に に に

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**NAME · なまえ**

# ぬ

*nu*

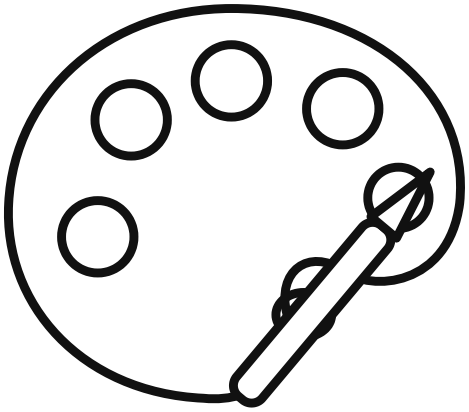
**SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE**

‘noo’ as in “noodle”

**FIFTY-SOUND CHART · KATAKANA**

な に **ぬ** ね の

Katakana twin: ヌ



**ぬ IS FOR**

# ぬりえ

*nurie*

**coloring picture**

Color the picture and say the word three times!

**TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · かいてみよう**

ぬ ぬ ぬ ぬ

This page is left blank on purpose, so your colours don’t bleed through. ✿

ね

**NAME · なまえ**

**ね**

*ne*

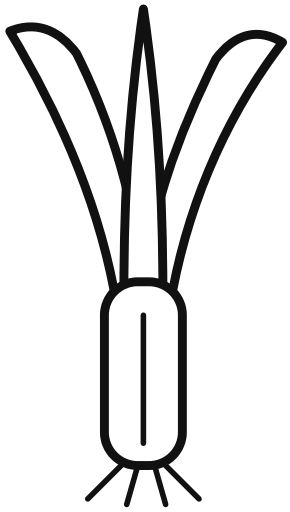
**SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE**

'ne' as in "net"

**FIFTY-SOUND CHART · KATAKANA**

な に ぬ [ね] の

Katakana twin: ネ



**ね IS FOR**

# ねぎ

*negi*

**green onion**

Color the picture and say the word three times!

**TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · かいてみよう**

ね ね ね ね

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の

**NAME · なまえ**

# の

*no*

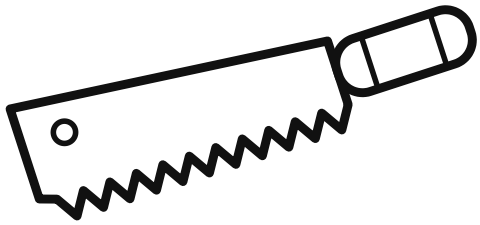
**SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE**

‘no’ as in “note”, short

**FIFTY-SOUND CHART · KATAKANA**

な に ぬ ね **の**

Katakana twin: ノ



**の IS FOR**

# のこぎり

*nokogiri*

**saw**

Color the picture and say the word three times!

**TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · かいてみよう**

の の の の

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# は

**NAME · なまえ**

**は**

*ha*

**SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE**

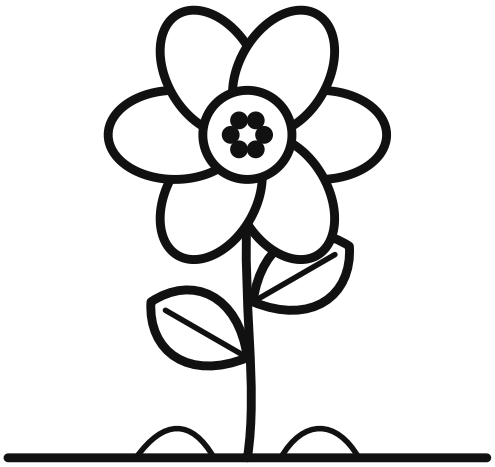
'hah'; as the little word "wa" it says 'wa'

**FIFTY-SOUND CHART · KATAKANA**

**は** ひ ふ へ ほ

Katakana twin: ハ · with ゛ : ば *ba* · with ゜ : ぱ *pa*

In こんにちは (hello) the last は is read 'wa'.



**は IS FOR**

## はな

*hana*

**flower**

Color the picture and say the word three times!

**TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · かいてみよう**

は は は は

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ひ

NAME · なまえ

**ひ**

*hi*

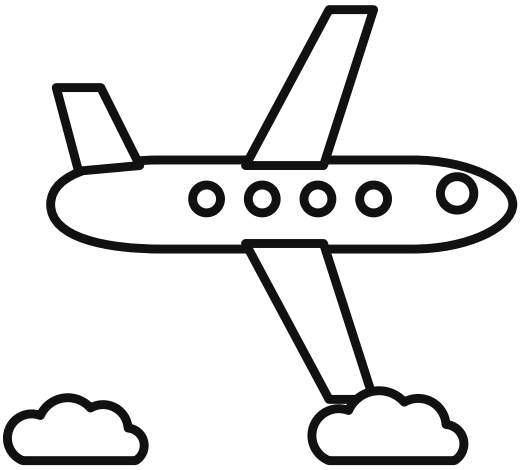
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

'hee' as in "heel"

FIFTY-SOUND CHART · KATAKANA

は **ひ** ふ へ ほ

Katakana twin: ヒ · with ゛ : び *bi* · with ゜ : ぴ *pi*



ひ IS FOR

# ひこうき

*hikooki*

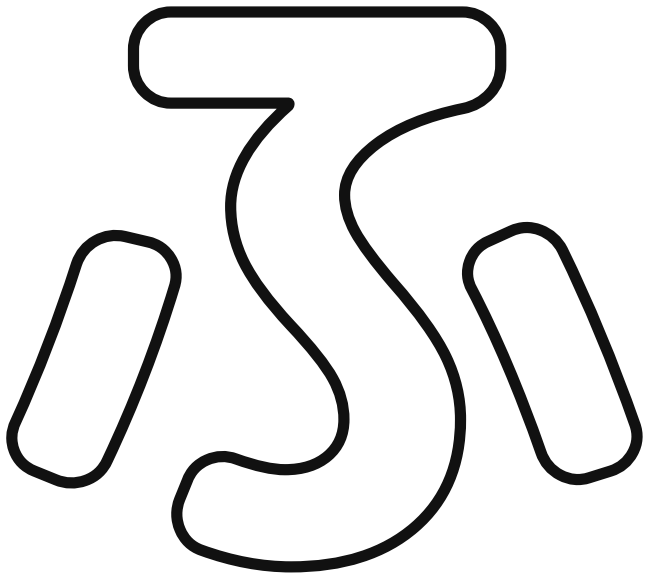
**airplane**

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · かいてみよう

ひ ひ ひ ひ

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**NAME · なまえ**

# ふ

*fu*

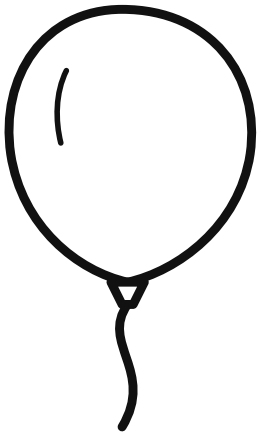
**SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE**

a soft ‘f’ blown between the lips, half-way to ‘hoo’

**FIFTY-SOUND CHART · KATAKANA**

は ひ **ふ** へ ほ

Katakana twin: フ · with ゛ : ぶ *bu* · with ゜ : ぷ *pu*



**ふ IS FOR**

# ふうせん

*fuusen*

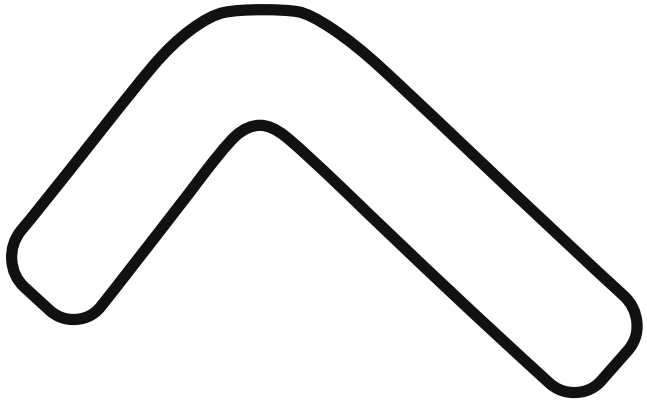
**balloon**

Color the picture and say the word three times!

**TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · かいてみよう**

ふ ふ ふ ふ

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NAME · なまえ

へ

*he*

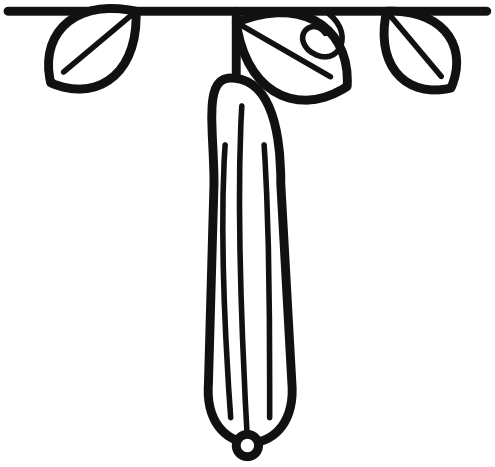
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

'he' as in "hen"; as the little word "e" (to) it says 'e'

FIFTY-SOUND CHART · KATAKANA

は ひ ふ **へ** ほ

Katakana twin: ヘ · with ゛ : べ *be* · with ゜ : ぺ *pe*



へ IS FOR

# へちま

*hechima*

**loofah gourd**

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · かいてみよう

へ へ へ へ

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# ほ

**NAME · なまえ**

**ほ**

*ho*

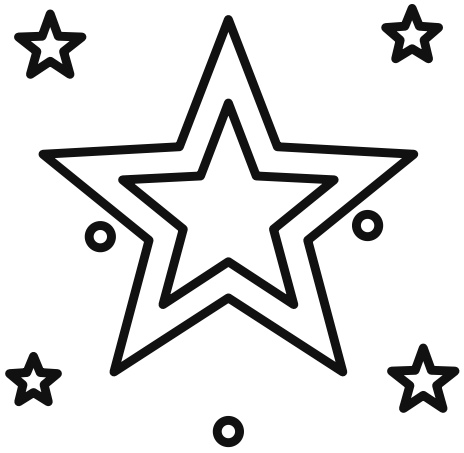
**SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE**

'ho' as in "hope", short

**FIFTY-SOUND CHART · KATAKANA**

は ひ ふ へ [ほ]

Katakana twin: ホ · with ゛ : ぼ *bo* · with ゜ : ぽ *po*



**ほ IS FOR**

## ほし

*hoshi*

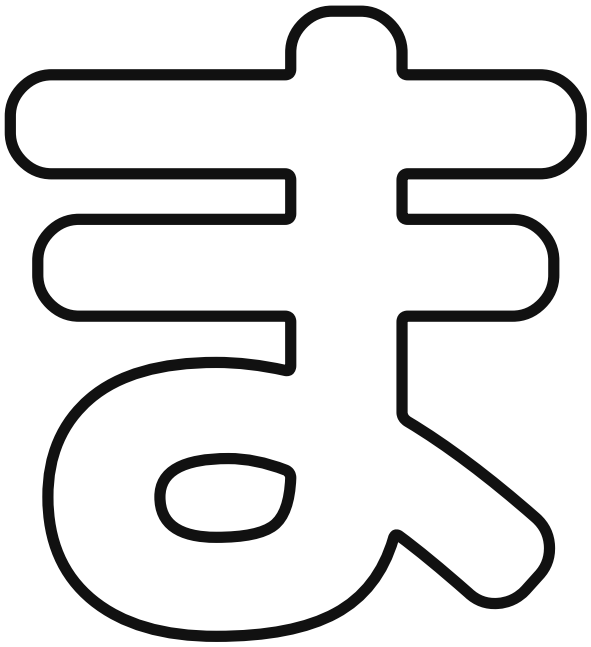
**star**

Color the picture and say the word three times!

**TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · かいてみよう**

ほ ほ ほ ほ

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**NAME · なまえ**

# ま

*ma*

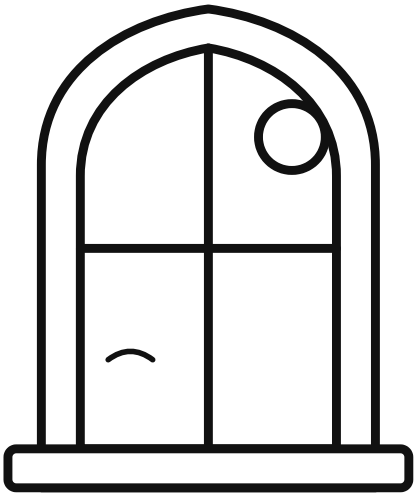
**SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE**

'mah'

**FIFTY-SOUND CHART · KATAKANA**

ま み む め も

Katakana twin: マ



**ま IS FOR**

# まど

*mado*

**window**

Color the picture and say the word three times!

**TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · かいてみよう**

ま ま ま ま

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# み

**NAME · なまえ**

**み**

*mi*

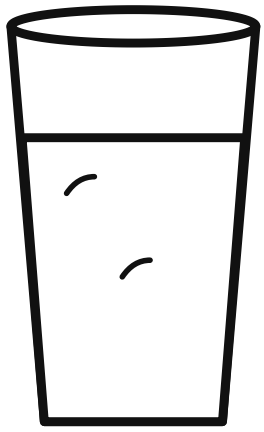
**SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE**

‘mee’ as in “meet”

**FIFTY-SOUND CHART · KATAKANA**

ま **み** む め も

Katakana twin: 三



**み IS FOR**

## みず

*mizu*

**water**

Color the picture and say the word three times!

**TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · かいてみよう**

み み み み

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# む

**NAME · なまえ**

**む**

*mu*

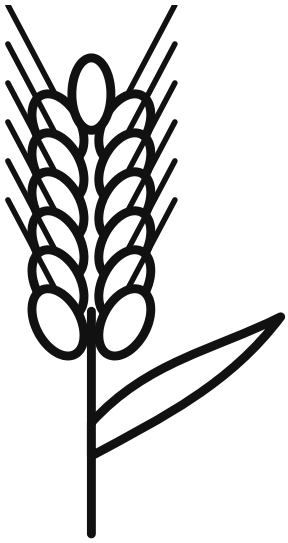
**SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE**

‘moo’

**FIFTY-SOUND CHART · KATAKANA**

ま み **む** め も

Katakana twin: ム



**む IS FOR**

## むぎ

*mugi*

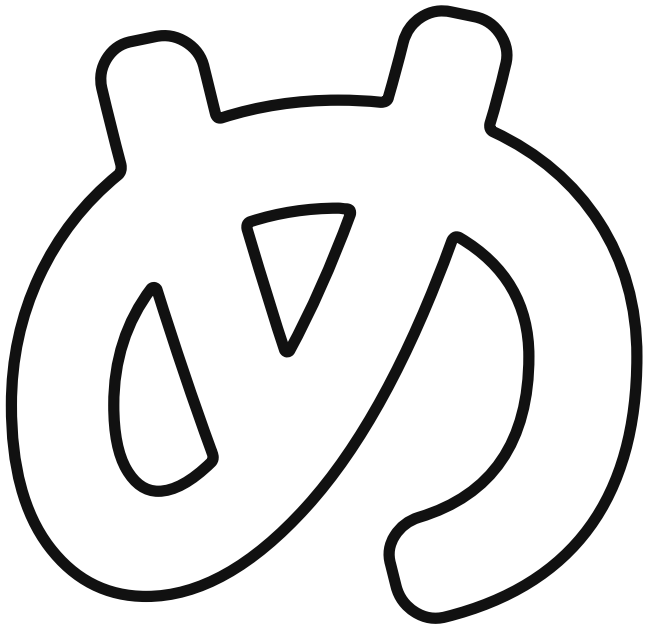
**wheat**

Color the picture and say the word three times!

**TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · かいてみよう**

む む む む

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**NAME · なまえ**

# め

*me*

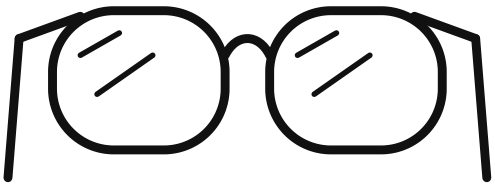
**SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE**

‘me’ as in “met”

**FIFTY-SOUND CHART · KATAKANA**

ま み む **め** も

Katakana twin: メ



**め IS FOR**

# めがね

*megane*

**glasses**

Color the picture and say the word three times!

**TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · かいてみよう**

め め め め

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# も

**NAME · なまえ**

**も**

*mo*

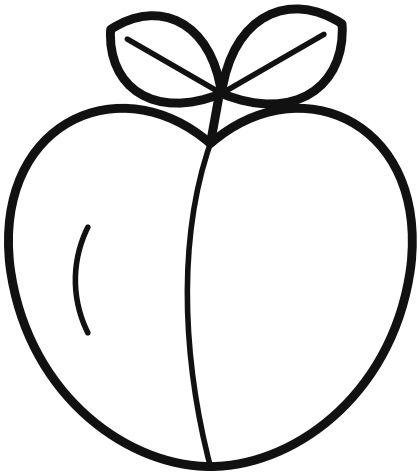
**SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE**

‘mo’ as in “more”, short

**FIFTY-SOUND CHART · KATAKANA**

ま み む め **も**

Katakana twin: モ



**も IS FOR**

## もも

*momo*

**peach**

Color the picture and say the word three times!

**TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · かいてみよう**

も も も も

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ROWS Y · R · W · N

# The Last Rows や・ら・わ・ん

*ya*, *ra*, *wa*, *n*

The last rows: **Y**, **R** and **W**, and the letter ん.

**Only three in the Y row**
や ゆ よ — and their small forms join other letters: き + ゃ = きゃ (*kya*).

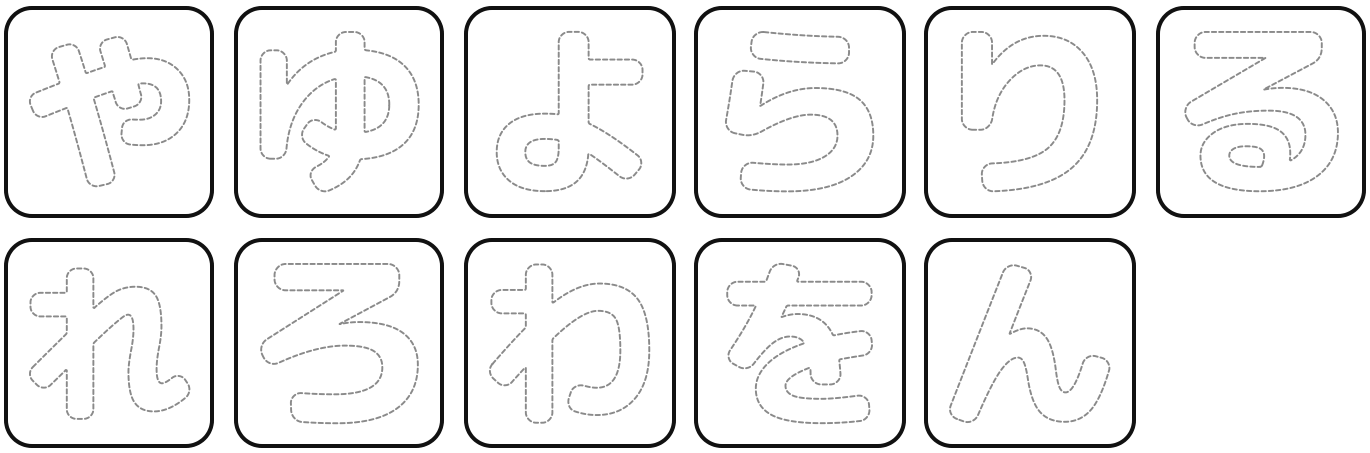
**A tapped R**
Japanese *r* is a quick tap of the tongue behind the top teeth, somewhere between English r, l and d.

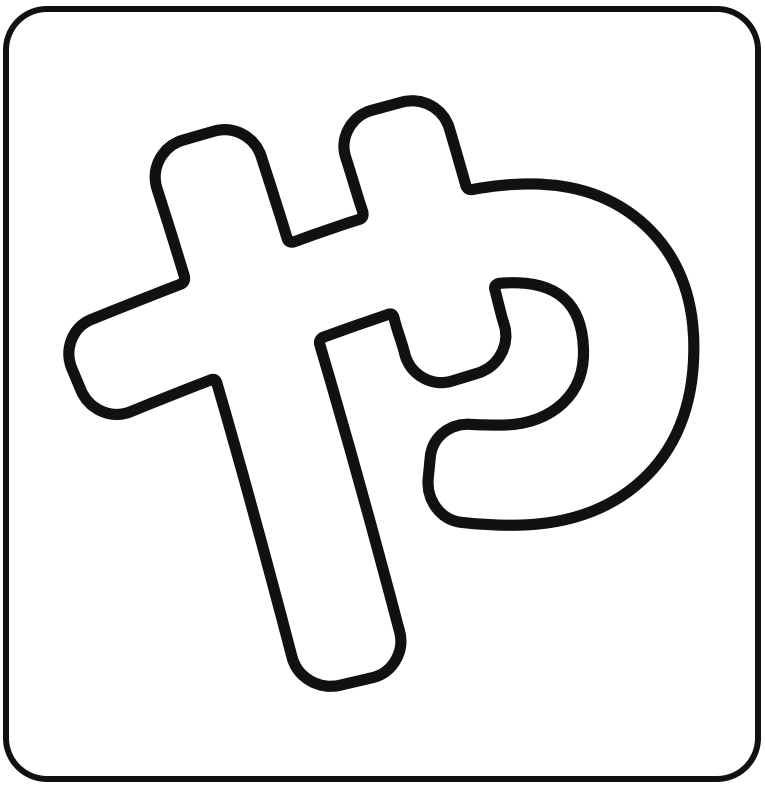
**Two special letters**
を sounds like お but is only used as a little word in a sentence, and ん is the only letter that is a sound all by itself, without a vowel.

PENCIL WARM-UP

# Trace the last rows や・ら・わ・ん

Use a **pencil**. Say each letter's name as you trace it.





**NAME · なまえ**

**や**

*ya*

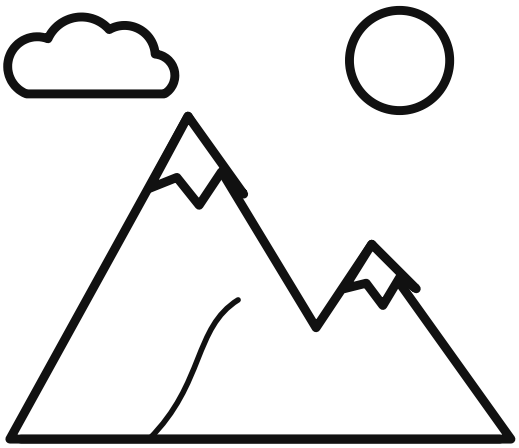
**SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE**

'ya' as in "yard"

**FIFTY-SOUND CHART · KATAKANA**

や ゆ よ

Katakana twin: ヤ



**や IS FOR**

# やま

*yama*

**mountain**

Color the picture and say the word three times!

**TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · かいてみよう**

や や や や

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ゆ

**NAME · なまえ**

**ゆ**

*yu*

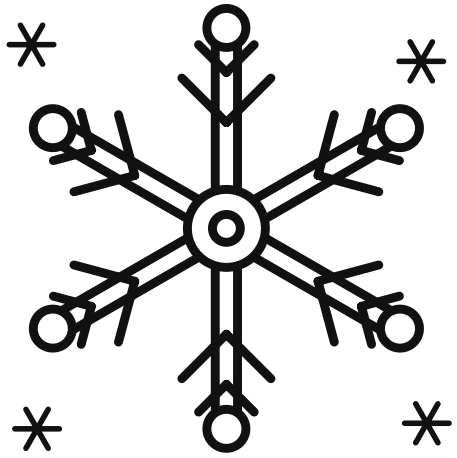
**SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE**

‘you’

**FIFTY-SOUND CHART · KATAKANA**

や **ゆ** よ

Katakana twin: ユ



**ゆ IS FOR**

# ゆき

*yuki*

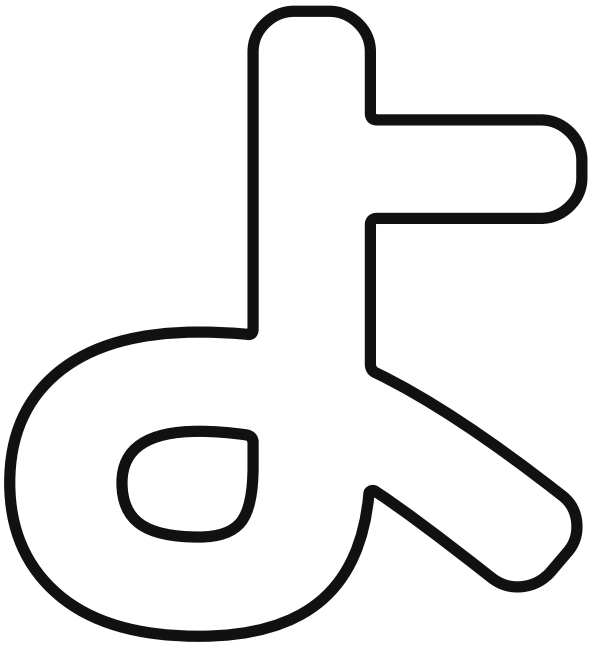
**snow**

Color the picture and say the word three times!

**TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · かいてみよう**

ゆ ゆ ゆ ゆ

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**NAME · なまえ**

# よ

*yo*

**SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE**

‘yo’ as in “yoga”

**FIFTY-SOUND CHART · KATAKANA**

や ゆ **よ**

Katakana twin: ヨ



**よ IS FOR**

# よる

*yoru*

**night**

Color the picture and say the word three times!

**TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · かいてみよう**

よ よ よ よ

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# ら

**NAME · なまえ**

ら

*ra*

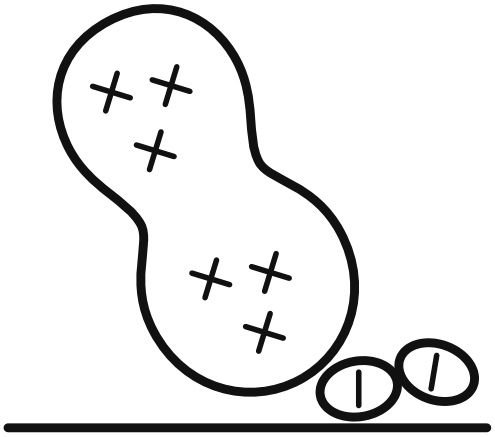
**SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE**

‘ra’ with a light tap of the tongue, half-way between r, l and d

**FIFTY-SOUND CHART · KATAKANA**

ら り る れ ろ

Katakana twin: ラ



**ら IS FOR**

## らっかせい

*rakkasei*

**peanuts**

Color the picture and say the word three times!

**TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · かいてみよう**

ら ら ら ら

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り

**NAME · なまえ**

り

*ri*

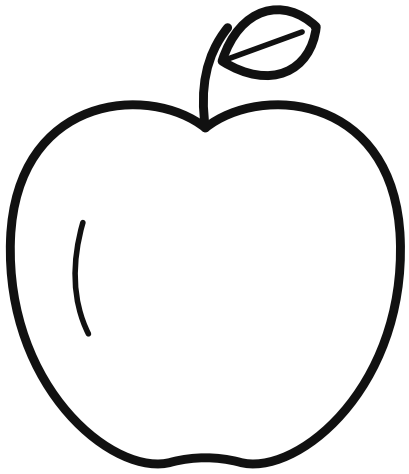
**SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE**

'ree', with a light tap

**FIFTY-SOUND CHART · KATAKANA**

ら **り** る れ ろ

Katakana twin: リ



**り IS FOR**

# りんご

*ringo*

**apple**

Color the picture and say the word three times!

**TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · かいてみよう**

り り り り

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る

**NAME · なまえ**

# る

*ru*

**SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE**

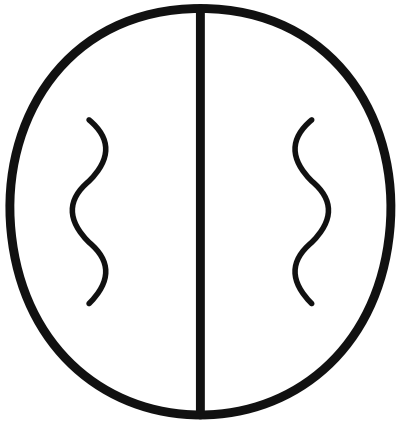
'roo', with a light tap

**FIFTY-SOUND CHART · KATAKANA**

ら り **る** れ ろ

Katakana twin: ル

Few words start with る. Find it in the middle of くるみ!



**る IS FOR**

# くるみ

*kurumi*

**walnut**

Color the picture and say the word three times!

**TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · かいてみよう**

る る る る

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れ

**NAME · なまえ**

**れ**

*re*

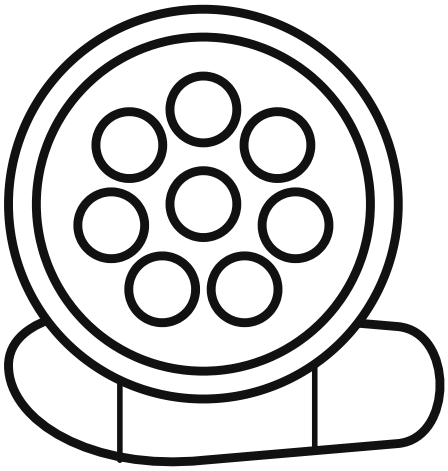
**SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE**

're' as in "red", with a light tap

**FIFTY-SOUND CHART · KATAKANA**

ら り る れ ろ

Katakana twin: レ



**れ IS FOR**

# れんこん

*renkon*

**lotus root**

Color the picture and say the word three times!

**TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · かいてみよう**

れ れ れ れ

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ろ

NAME · なまえ

ろ

*ro*

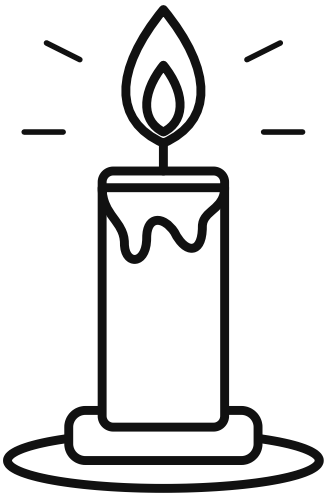
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

'ro' as in "road", short, with a light tap

FIFTY-SOUND CHART · KATAKANA

ら り る れ ろ

Katakana twin: □



ろ IS FOR

# ろうそく

*roosoku*

**candle**

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · かいてみよう

ろ ろ ろ ろ

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わ

**NAME · なまえ**

# わ

*wa*

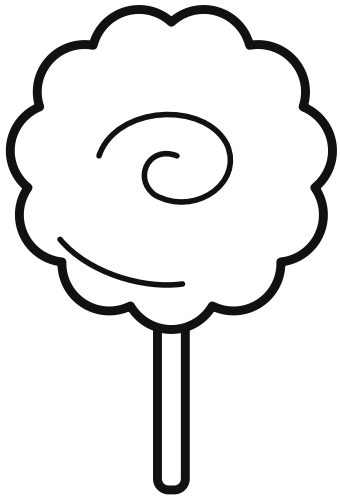
**SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE**

‘wa’ as in “wasp”

**FIFTY-SOUND CHART · KATAKANA**

わ を

Katakana twin: ワ



**わ IS FOR**

# わたあめ

*wataame*

**cotton candy**

Color the picture and say the word three times!

**TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · かいてみよう**

わ わ わ わ

This page is left blank on purpose, so your colours don’t bleed through. ✿

# を

NAME · なまえ

**を**

*o*

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘o’, just like お

FIFTY-SOUND CHART · KATAKANA

わ [を]

Katakana twin: ヲ

を is only used as a little word after the thing you act on: ほんを よむ, “read a book”.




を IS FOR

## ほんを よむ

*hon o yomu*

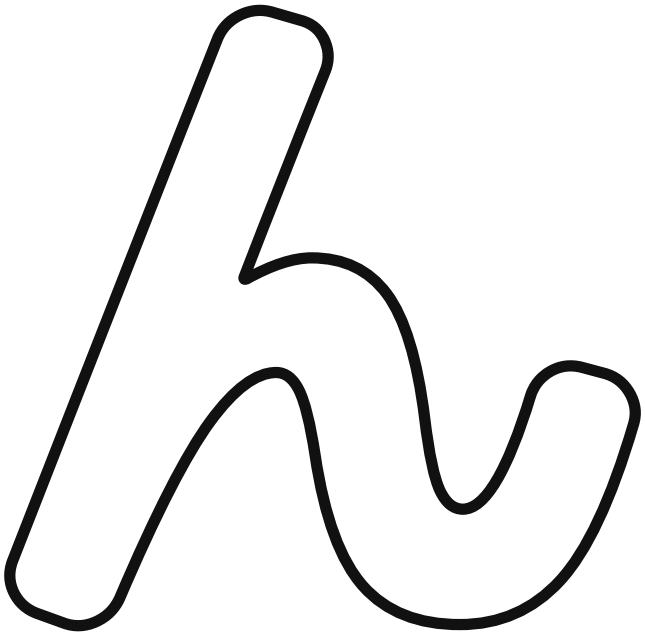
**read a book**

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · かいてみよう

を を を を

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**NAME · なまえ**

**ん**

*n*

**SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE**

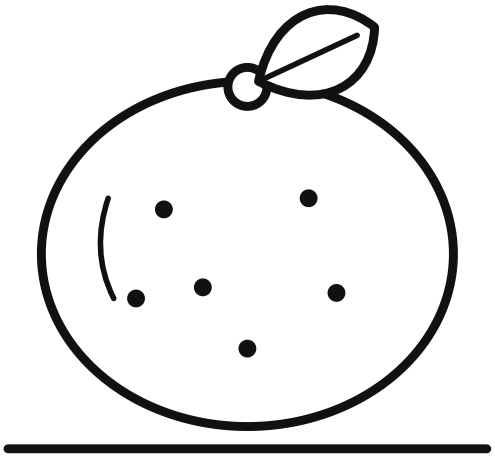
a humming ‘n’ that takes a whole beat

**FIFTY-SOUND CHART · KATAKANA**

ん

Katakana twin: ン

ん never starts a word. Find it at the end of みかん!



**ん IS FOR**

# みかん

*mikan*

**mandarin orange**

Color the picture and say the word three times!

**TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · かいてみよう**

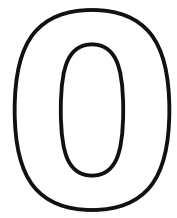
ん ん ん ん

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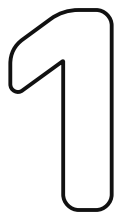
BONUS

# Japanese numbers かず *(kazu)*

Color the numbers and count out loud in Japanese: *zero*, *ichi*, *ni*, *san*...



**0**
**ゼロ**
*zero*
zero



**1**
**一・いち**
*ichi*
one



**2**
**二・に**
*ni*
two



**3**
**三・さん**
*san*
three



**4**
**四・よん**
*yon*
four



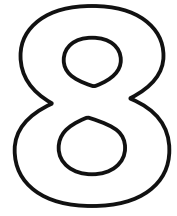
**5**
**五・ご**
*go*
five



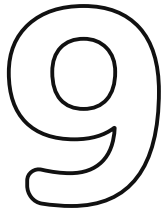
**6**
**六・ろく**
*roku*
six



**7**
**七・なな**
*nana*
seven



**8**
**八・はち**
*hachi*
eight



**9**
**九・きゅう**
*kyuu*
nine

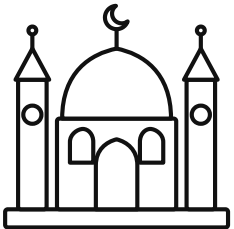
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LET'S TALK

# My first Japanese words はじめての ことば

Now that you know the letters, try saying these with your family.

| | |
|---|---|
| アッサラーム・アライクム | *assalaamu alaikum*<br>**Peace be upon you (the Muslim greeting)** |
| ワ・アライクム・アッサラーム | *wa alaikum assalaam*<br>**And upon you be peace (the reply)** |
| こんにちは | *konnichiwa*<br>**Hello!** |
| わたしの なまえは … です | *watashi no namae wa … desu*<br>**My name is …** |
| ありがとう | *arigatoo*<br>**Thank you** |
| ジャザーカッラーフ・ハイラン | *jazaakallaahu khairan*<br>**May Allah reward you with good** |
| おかあさん・おとうさん | *okaasan · otoosan*<br>**Mother · Father** |
| おにいさん・おねえさん | *oniisan · oneesan*<br>**Big brother · Big sister** |
| はい・いいえ | *hai · iie*<br>**Yes · No** |
| にほんごを べんきょう しています！ | *nihongo o benkyoo shite imasu!*<br>**I am learning Japanese!** |







REFERENCES & SOURCES

# Where our facts come from

[1] **The Noble Qur'an** — Surah Ar-Raḥmān 55:1–4, Surah Ar-Rūm 30:22 and Surah Al-Ḥujurāt 49:13. Arabic text and meanings checked against **Quran.com**; the English meanings in this book are simplified for children.

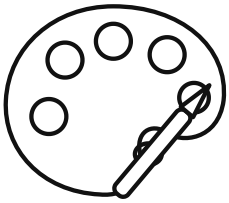
[2] **Map** — outlines from **Natural Earth** (public domain), via the *world-atlas* data set.

[3] **Language facts** — speaker numbers from **Ethnologue** (SIL International); the first-year kanji list from Japan's **Ministry of Education (MEXT)**.

**What's next?**
You have met all **46 Japanese letters**! Keep practising by reading signs, books and food packets written in Japanese, and look out for the other books in the **Allamahul Bayan Series**, in shā' Allāh.

**Enjoyed this book?**
A short review on Amazon helps other families find it — *jazākumullāhu khayran!*





# Certificate of Achievement

## マーシャーアッラー！ よく できました！

*maashaa-allaah! yoku dekimashita! — Mashallah! Well done!*

This certifies that

_____

has learned, traced and colored
**all 46 letters of the Japanese alphabet**.

Date _____ Grown-up's signature _____

*Minhaz Reza*

Hafez Abdullah Muhammad Minhaz Reza, author

**Maktabatu Kunujul Akhirah** — Publisher
An imprint of the Kunujul Akhirah Charitable Trust
مكتبة كنوز الآخرة

✂ Cut out and frame it — the back of this page is blank.